

Philipp Hilbert. *Product Manager, Data Onboarding.*

Positioning, ten years owning data pipelines, ETL migrations, and onboarding tooling across regulated B2B SaaS, now applied to getting liquor retailers live faster.

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§ WHY SCOTCH

Scotch is solving exactly the problem legacy POS data creates: years of inconsistent records, proprietary formats, and no clean migration path, and the install day that follows is the first trust signal a retailer gets. The framing of "making install day a non-event" is precise, and the path from high-touch specialist workflows to self-serve onboarding is a product arc I have run before in healthcare and insurance SaaS. The \$1B+ in processed payment volume and 500%+ YoY growth tells me the core platform is working; data onboarding is now the rate-limiter on how fast that scales. *That is exactly the constraint I am built to remove.*

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo spec drafts and edge-case generation
- **GitHub Copilot**, day-to-day code review and scaffolding
- **Cursor**, LLM-assisted requirements and test generation
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping for internal tooling
- **GPT**, discovery synthesis and stakeholder write-ups
- **n8n**, agentic workflow automation and process integration
- **Gamma.app**, executive and go-to-market presentations
- **Framer**, design-heavy prototype surfaces

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

ETL pipelines with Dagster and dbt; PostgreSQL and MongoDB for data storage; Kubernetes, Docker, ArgoCD, and GitOps rollout and rollback; Jenkins CI/CD; REST APIs; Python, Kotlin, SQL; Jira, Confluence, and Azure DevOps for delivery; Shopware for e-commerce; Kafka for event streaming.

§ SIDE PROJECT

CONSTRUCT8 [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

A two-sided B2B marketplace for construction staffing, built zero-to-one.

- Anonymity-until-payment model that protects both sides until commitment is established.
 - WhatsApp and Telegram as the product surface, with LLM agents running the funnel end-to-end.
 - Funnel and conversion analysis in SQL; one operator runs the day-to-day.
 - Directly relevant: designing self-serve, low-friction onboarding flows where the specialist is eventually taken out of the loop.
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§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT SCOTCH

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow every onboarding specialist call and instrument the current install workflow in detail, mapping where legacy POS data breaks, where manual cleaning happens, and where the customer loses confidence, before touching the roadmap.

WEEK 2

Slice and validate.

Pick the single highest-cost manual step in data transformation, draft a clear requirement with measurable success criteria (time-to-live, specialist hours per install), and align engineering and go-to-market on scope.

WEEK 3+

Ship, measure, automate.

Deliver the first automation increment, instrument it against the baseline, and open the backlog item for the next specialist-time-to-zero slice, iterating toward self-serve onboarding one validated step at a time.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Scotch hiring team,

I am applying for the Product Manager role on your Data Onboarding team. I read the posting carefully, and the problem description is precise enough that I want to engage with it directly rather than pitch generically.

Getting a liquor retailer live means parsing years of legacy POS data that was never designed to be exported, cleaning it without breaking the relationships between items, vendors, and prices, and then handing a store owner a system they trust on day one. I have run a version of this problem twice at meaningful scale. At the Bundesagentur für Arbeit I owned the ETL pipeline for a national labour-market analytics platform: I introduced Dagster and dbt to replace hand-held quarterly imports, cutting data update time by roughly 75%, and I carried a full bare-metal-to-container migration in the same period without disrupting production. At Rohde & Schwarz I owned the data platform for the FCAS European defence programme, the challenge there was not just the pipeline but making the platform trustworthy enough that multinational engineering teams would actually run their workloads on it. I instrumented two competing delivery workflows and discovered that the visually polished UI-led path recorded exactly zero clicks; redirecting to developer-code-first increased pipeline runs by 200%.

The self-serve trajectory you describe, from specialist-heavy installs toward something the retailer does themselves, is a product arc I have thought about and shipped before. At CLINET Platforms I took a five-person healthcare team with an undeliverable roadmap, cut it to the top 10% of features against agreed success criteria, and then implemented the CGM interface into hospital information system workflows, reducing the digital anamnesis from 30 minutes to 5. The mechanic is the same: identify where specialist time is spent, automate or simplify that step, measure, repeat. At Emil Group I shipped the Claims Center from concept to production and cut time-to-market for a new insurance product from months to under a week, in a B2B SaaS platform context not unlike what Scotch is building.

On AI tooling: I use Claude Code and Cursor daily for spec drafting and edge-case generation, Lovable for rapid internal tooling prototypes, and n8n for agentic workflow automation. The posting specifically mentions developing Claude skills for your own workflows, I build and

iterate on these regularly, and I see them as a genuine multiplier on discovery and requirements work, not a credential to name-drop.

Scotch is early enough that my work would shape the onboarding platform's architecture, not just fill a roadmap slot. The combination of payments infrastructure, retail operations, and data migration in a single product is the kind of cross-stack scope that most PM roles at this stage do not offer. I would like to bring my experience from regulated data pipelines, B2B SaaS onboarding, and self-serve automation to the problem of getting liquor retailers live faster and with more confidence.

I am happy to walk through any of the specifics above in a conversation.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Product Manager with 13 years of product ownership across regulated B2B SaaS, data platforms, and operational onboarding workflows. At the Bundesagentur für Arbeit I owned a national ETL platform and cut data-update time by 75% through pipeline automation. At Rohde & Schwarz I ran a cross-functional team of 15+ through GitOps delivery that took rollout from days to 30 minutes. I specialise in turning high-touch, specialist-dependent processes into scalable, instrumented, increasingly self-serve systems.

§ WHAT I CAN DO

Data and ETL: ETL (extract, transform, load), Dagster, dbt (data build tool), PostgreSQL, data migration, data quality, pipeline automation, funnel and churn analysis, KPI definition, MicroStrategy, Matomo, SQL, MongoDB, Kafka.

Product Management: continuous discovery, product vision and roadmap, prioritisation, MVP definition, PoC, A/B testing, user research, prototyping, product lifecycle management, go-to-market support.

Platform and SaaS delivery: payments, e-commerce, platform product ownership, B2B SaaS, Shopware, REST APIs.

AI Products and Tooling: LLM agents, agentic workflows, prompt and context engineering, evaluation loops, human-in-the-loop design, AI governance, EU AI Act, Explainable AI (XAI); Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Lovable, n8n.

Product Ownership: requirements engineering, user stories, acceptance criteria, backlog refinement, sprint planning, velocity, release planning, UAT, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

Agile and Scaled Delivery: Agile, Scrum, Kanban, SAFe, ART, PI planning, GitOps with ArgoCD, CI/CD, Jenkins, containerised environments, Kubernetes, Docker.

Stakeholder and Leadership: stakeholder management, cross-functional team leadership, C-level reporting, workshop facilitation, conflict resolution, change management.

Governance: GDPR, Deputy IT Security Officer, identity management, budget ownership, ROI reasoning.

§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ · PRODUCT MANAGER · DEFENCE AI PLATFORM 2024-2025

GitOps rollout via ArgoCD cut deployment from days to 30 minutes; 200% pipeline-run increase after workflow instrumentation redirected strategy; led 15+ engineers and data scientists through Scrum across multinational teams. Python, Kubernetes, ArgoCD, Dagster.

BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT · PRODUCT MANAGER · PUBLIC-SECTOR DATA PLATFORM 2023-2024

Introduced Dagster and dbt for ETL automation, saving ~75% of time per data update; migrated bare-metal to containers; Deputy IT Security Officer. Jenkins, dbt, Dagster, PostgreSQL.

CLINET PLATFORMS · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE MOBILE APP 2023

Cut roadmap to top 10% of features; user acceptance rose fivefold. Implemented CGM/KIS interface reducing anamnesis from 30 min to 5 min.

EMIL GROUP · PRODUCT MANAGER · INSURANCE B2B SAAS PLATFORM 2022

Restructured 18-person org into three lean teams; reduced attrition from near-total exodus to one departure. Shipped Claims Center from concept to production; cut new-product launch from months to under one week.

SCHEIDT & BACHMANN · PRODUCT OWNER · RETAIL POS AND PAYMENTS 2021-2022

Moved research into production across a matrix organisation in a full SAFe setup with agile release trains and PI planning. Retail operations, POS systems, payments.

BUNDESDRUCKEREI · PRODUCT OWNER (INTERIM) · SECURE GOVERNMENT DATA PLATFORM 2021

Data structures and identity management for Robert Koch Institute programmes DIM and DESH.

AOK ITSCARE · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTH INSURANCE E-COMMERCE 2019-2020

Migrated legacy system to Shopware for three AOK insurers and ~20,000 employees; still in production. Backlog refinement, user stories, acceptance criteria in Jira.

ENERCON · PROJECT LEAD · WIND ENERGY IT 2019

Full site IT modernisation end to end.

WALDBURG-ZEIL KLINIKEN · PRODUCT OWNER · CLINICAL NETWORK 2017-2018

Wifi infrastructure rollout across nine hospitals.

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

CONSTRUCT8 · FOUNDER AND PRODUCT MANAGER · CONSTRUCTION STAFFING MARKETPLACE 2025-2026

Zero-to-one B2B two-sided marketplace. Anonymity-until-payment model; WhatsApp and Telegram as product surface; LLM agents across the funnel; SQL funnel analysis.

QCRYPT AG · CO-FOUNDER AND PRODUCT OWNER · QUANTUM-SECURE ENCRYPTION 2016-2021

Shipped a three-layer hardware-software product that installs in under two minutes. Later Chair of the board.

SMART SOIL TECHNOLOGIES · CO-FOUNDER, CDO AND CFO · AGRICULTURE NANOTECHNOLOGY 2018-2021

Lab to investor rounds; owned financial planning and investor reporting.

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS · FOUNDER AND CFO · FINTECH P2P PAYMENTS 2013-2018

Built from zero to acquisition; acquired and operated by Sparkasse inside the girocard ecosystem.

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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TRUE NORTH · APPLICATION PACKAGE · SCOTCH

